Prior Authorization and Medical Necessity Policy

Synthetic training document for an educational RAG project. This is not an official Aetna policy or plan document.

Overview

Prior authorization is a review process used before selected services, procedures, medications, or equipment are provided. It helps confirm that the request meets plan and medical-necessity criteria.

Services Commonly Requiring Review

Examples include inpatient admissions, advanced imaging, selected outpatient procedures, durable medical equipment, specialty medications, and certain behavioral health services.

Submission Requirements

A request may include member information, ordering provider details, requested service, diagnosis, clinical notes, test results, treatment history, and the requested date or duration.

Decision Process

Possible outcomes include approved, denied, partially approved, or pended for additional information. Urgent requests may follow an expedited review path.

Prior Authorization Reference

Service Type	PA Required	Typical Supporting Information
MRI / CT	Yes for selected plans	Diagnosis, clinical notes, prior testing
Inpatient admission	Yes	Admission reason, treatment plan
Routine primary care	No	Not applicable
Specialty medication	Often	Diagnosis, prior therapies, labs